



Something for everyone

Facebook is looking at helping creators connect with fans through new features.
<https://dgit.in/oct22-39>



Humans in space

NASA has finally released its final blueprint for sustained human presence in space.
<https://dgit.in/oct22-40>

OnePlus Nord Buds CE

Decent at best

The OnePlus Nord Buds CE, as the name suggests, are an addition to that same line of products, joining the OnePlus Nord Buds in OnePlus' quest to stand tall against competitors like Realme, Xiaomi, and Oppo. So, to gauge whether OnePlus' latest offering can stand up to the claims and competition it faces, we put the OnePlus Nord Buds CE to the test at the Digit Test Centre. Here's what we found out.

BUILD AND FIT

OnePlus Nord Buds CE come in an oval-shaped charging case which is made with glossy plastic and sports a subtle OnePlus branding on the front. Fresh out of the box, the case looks absolutely beautiful. However, even if you use it carefully, it tends to pick up scratches with time, dampening the looks. The hinge connecting the rest of the case to the lid, due to the lack of a strong opening and closing mechanism, felt loose and quite flimsy. When it comes to the buds, they also carry over the same colour scheme as the case. They have a long stem, which we are generally not big fans of. The buds slid in and out of the case with ease. They have what we call here the AirPods-esque design, meaning that the fit was polarising. As for the controls, they are embedded at the top of the stem, with the touch-sensitive region having a matte finish compared to the rest of the buds. The sensitivity of the touch sensors is great, and the slightly different finish on the stem makes it easier to recognise the touch-sensitive areas. As a package, these look exactly what you pay for them. Not overtly cheap, and not in the top brass either.

FEATURES

While you may see many pairs of earbuds that are extremely popular in this price range, the OnePlus Nord Buds CE are inclined towards keeping



things simple. For EQ and other customisations, these rely on the HeyMelody app when connected to non-OnePlus devices and OnePlus' offerings below OnePlus 6. For devices newer than the OnePlus 6, all the functions of the HeyMelody app can be found in the device settings itself. The documentation may not say so, but other devices on ColorOS 11.0+ can find the same settings as the newer OnePlus devices baked into the settings. The earbuds come with a low latency Game Mode, which as advertised by OnePlus, brings down the latency to 94ms. The Bluetooth 5.2 connectivity with OnePlus Fast Pair, ensures that there is a seamless and lag-free connection maintained between your device and the earbuds.

PERFORMANCE

When it comes to performance, there is nothing to write home about the OnePlus Nord Buds CE. The sound signature of the earbuds is bass-heavy. The mids are also underemphasised. To add to the misery is the fact that the design of the earbuds, due to the poor frequency response of the drivers,

brings down the overall listening experience by quite a bit. Comparatively, the Nord Buds, which retail for about ₹500 more, perform relatively much better. However, when strictly looking ₹100 on either side of the ₹2,299 price point of the OnePlus Nord Buds CE, then these are an enticing deal. Also lacking in these earbuds is Active Noise Cancelling. It would be nice to have addition, but considering the price, we did not set our expectations high. When it comes to microphones, during calls in indoor environments, the mics perform well. As soon as you have some background noise, these do not do a good job separating the audio, so your voice ends up being muffled.

BATTERY LIFE

The battery life on the One Plus Nord Buds CE was sub-par.

They capped out at just 18

with some spare charge left in the case. The buds themselves lasted for about 4 hours and 30 minutes in our battery test, where we placed them at 50 per cent volume levels. OnePlus also advertises fast

charging on these earbuds, which as per their claims, provides 81 minutes of playback for a 10-minute charge.

VERDICT

All things considered, the OnePlus Nord Buds CE is a decent buy if you are already a fan of the brand or are looking for a pair of earbuds that you can rely on for calls in the office or at home. Otherwise, there are a bunch of options available in the market that bring many more features to the table and would also have a decked-out spec sheet.

—Sativik Pandey

SPECIFICATIONS

CASE DIMENSIONS: Width - 35.92 mm Height - 18.47 mm Depth - 17.02 mm | WATER RESISTANCE: IPX4 | MICROPHONE: Yes | DRIVERS: 13.4 mm Titanium Drivers | BATTERY LIFE: Playback: 4.5 hours, Phone call: 3 hours | BATTERY CAPACITY - Per earbud: 27 mAh, Charging case: 300 mAh | SUPPORTED AUDIO FORMATS - AAC, SBC

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